

December 20, 1948

Mr. William Jack Stone, Director
Intercultural Project
San Diego City Schools
825 Union Street
San Diego 1, California

Dear Mr. Stone:

I have examined the specifications for the Mexico Text Project. I find them very good and have only one suggestion to offer: One of the most important features of any culture is language. In studying Mexico, children should develop an appreciation for the fact that Mexican culture and the Spanish language are inseparable. The language is really the most foreign feature of a foreign culture. Too often, children develop understandings and appreciations about other peoples, but when they are later suddenly faced with the fact that those people speak a strange tongue, they are unable to carry over their understandings and appreciations to these strange speaking individuals or groups. Therefore, I deem it very important that in any project such as this, provision be made to have the children do some work in the foreign language that is involved.

Provision for language can be made by a wise use of commonplace names, phrases, songs, etc. Wherever translated meanings are required, the English of the translation should have the Spanish flavor: i.e., "I have ten years" instead of "I am ten years old" for "Tengo diez años." A judicious use of Spanish words and phrases, with appropriate explanation and glossary, will not only get across this language requirement but will add "local color" to the text.

Sincerely,

George I. Sánchez

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